

Guide to Developmental Stages of Children

1 month

- Makes crawling movements when prone
- When held in standing position, body limp at knees and hips
- In sitting position back is uniformly rounded, absence of head control

2 months

- Turns from side to back
- When prone, can lift head almost 45 degrees off table
- When held in sitting position, holds head up but head bobs forward

3 months

- Holds head high, makes crawling movements when prone
- Able to hold head more erect when sitting, but still bobs forward
- When held in standing position, able to bear slight fraction of weight on legs
- Supports weight on forearms
- Able to raise head and shoulders from prone position to 45-90 degree angle from table
- Opens hand spontaneously

4 months

- Rolls from back to side
- Able to sit erect if propped up
- Supports weight on feet briefly with underarm support

6 months

- When held in standing position, bears almost all of weight
- Sits with support
- Lifts legs high, holds them out straight

7 months

- Bears full weight on feet
- Rolls over easily
- Sits without support
- Pushes up on hands and knees and rocks

8 months

- Readily bears weight on legs when supported, may stand holding onto furniture
- Crawls on belly – arms used to pull body forward

9 months

- Crawls, may progress backward at first
- Sits steadily on floor for prolonged time (10 minutes)
- Pulls self to standing position and stands holding onto furniture
- Makes stepping movements

10 months

- Pulls self up
- Can hold bottle and feed self crackers
- Can drink from cup
- Crawls by pulling self forward with hands
- Pulls self to sitting position
- Stands while holding onto furniture, sits by falling down

12 months

- Begins to stand alone and toddle
- Uses spoon
- Cruises or walks holding onto furniture or with hand held
- May attempt to stand alone momentarily
- Can sit down from standing position without help

15 months

- Walks without help (usually since age 13 months)
- Creeps up stairs
- Assumes standing position without support
- Uses cup well
- Feeds self with regular cup with little spilling

18 months

- Runs clumsily, falls often
- Walks upstairs with one hand held
- Seats self on chair
- Manages spoon, but some spilling
- Takes off gloves, socks, and shoes and unzips

24 months

- Walks up and down stairs, has steady gait
- Holds cup for drinking
- Feeds self with spoon
- Cooperates with toilet training
- Runs fairly well, with wide stance
- Dresses self in simple clothing
- Participates in bathing

3 years

- Undresses self, washes and dries hands
- Feeds self with spoon
- May attend to toilet needs without help except for wiping
- Buttons and unbuttons accessible buttons
- Pulls on shoes
- Should have achieved daytime bowel and bladder control with occasional accidents

4 years

- Buttons front and side of clothes
- Bathes self with directions

5 years

- Has good motor control
- Washes self
- Cares for self totally, occasionally needing supervision in dress or hygiene
- Should have achieved daytime and nighttime bowel and bladder control